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The Government Teacher Recruitment Playbook 2026-27

From TET to appointment, in the right order

Why passing CTET does not get you a teaching job - and what does

The four gates: qualification, TET, recruitment exam, verification

Bihar TRE 4.0, UP TGT 2026 and AP DSC-2026 decoded from the notifications

Eligibility, age, subject combinations and the equivalence traps

The lifetime-validity change most candidates still do not know about

Negative marking, the option E rule, and a 90-day plan

Document verification: the full set, and the ten ways seats are lost

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A Digital Edition - the system, not the syllabus

How to use this book

This is a book about the machine, not the syllabus. If you want another question bank, there are hundreds. What is scarce is a straight account of how government teacher recruitment in India actually works in the 2026-27 cycle: which gate you are standing at, what each gate demands, which drives are open right now, and what happens after you clear them.

Read it in this order if you are starting from zero: chapters 1 to 3 tell you what the system is and what is live. Chapters 4 to 7 settle your eligibility, which is where most wasted years begin. Chapters 8 to 11 handle the eligibility test. Chapters 12 to 20 are the recruitment exams and how to prepare for them. Chapters 21 to 24 cover documents, rosters, pay and the ten ways candidates lose seats they had already won. Chapter 25 is printable worksheets.

Read it differently if you are already mid-cycle: go straight to the chapter for your drive - 12 for Bihar, 13 for Uttar Pradesh, 14 for Andhra Pradesh - then chapter 21 for documents, and keep chapter 15 open while you read the notification.

On accuracy

Every date, fee, mark, pay level and eligibility condition here was taken from an official document and checked on 30 October 2026. Where a number came from press reporting rather than an official source, the text says so. Dates move: Bihar's application deadline was extended once while this book was being written. Before you pay a fee, confirm the date on the official portal named in the chapter.

A note on what this book cannot do

It cannot tell you what your state will advertise next, and it cannot replace the notification for your post. Where the two disagree, the notification is right. Use this book to understand the structure and the traps quickly, then read the notification with chapter 15's twelve-point checklist beside you.

A word about the audience

This is written for the candidate who has finished a B.Ed or D.El.Ed, or is finishing one, and is trying to convert it into a government teaching post without losing another year to forms, dates and rejections. It assumes you are smart and short of time, and that nobody in your family has done this before. That is the majority of people who sit these exams.

Contents

How to use this book . . . 2
1. Passing CTET does not get you a teaching job . . . 4
2. Four kinds of employer, four different doors . . . 4
3. What is actually open in the 2026-27 cycle . . . 5
4. The four teaching levels, and what each one demands . . . 6
5. Marks, subject combinations, and the equivalence trap . . . 7
6. Age: the rule that quietly ends careers . . . 8
7. Your eligibility, on one page . . . 9
8. What a TET actually is . . . 10
9. Your TET certificate is valid for life - most people still do not know . . . 10
10. Pass marks are set by states, not by NCTE . . . 11
11. Which TET opens which door . . . 12
12. Bihar TRE 4.0, decoded . . . 13
13. Uttar Pradesh TGT 2026, decoded . . . 14
14. Andhra Pradesh DSC-2026, decoded . . . 15
15. Reading any state notification in twenty minutes . . . 17
16. Choosing your level and subject without wasting a cycle . . . 17
17. What these papers actually test . . . 18
18. Negative marking: the arithmetic nobody does . . . 18
25. Seven myths, checked against the documents . . . 19
26. The syllabus, section by section . . . 20
27. If your state is closed: the cross-state map . . . 21
28. Special education and physical education: the less crowded doors . . . 22
19. The 90-day plan . . . 24
20. Practice that actually transfers . . . 24
21. Document verification: the gate that rejects the qualified . . . 26
22. How merit, rosters and district cadre decide where you land . . . 27
23. What the job actually pays . . . 27
24. Ten ways candidates lose a seat they had already won . . . 28
29. Worksheets . . . 29
30. What to do in the next seven days . . . 31
31. Sources, and how this book was checked . . . 31

1. Passing CTET does not get you a teaching job

Start with the sentence that saves the most wasted years: a Teacher Eligibility Test certificate is a licence to be considered, not an appointment letter. It is the second of four separate gates, and most candidates spend all their energy on it while ignoring the two gates after it.

The Central Board of Secondary Education says this plainly in its own CTET frequently-asked-questions: qualifying CTET "would not confer a right on any person for recruitment/employment as it is only one of the eligibility criteria for appointment". Andhra Pradesh's Teacher Eligibility Test notification repeats the same line for its own state exam. Nobody is being modest - that is simply how the law is built.

Section 23(1) of the Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009 gives the National Council for Teacher Education the power to prescribe who may be appointed as a teacher. NCTE used that power in its notifications of 23 August 2010 and 29 July 2011 and made passing a Teacher Eligibility Test one essential qualification. It did not make it the only one, and it did not make it a job offer.

The four gates, in order

1. Academic and professional qualification - your degree, your B.Ed or D.El.Ed, your subject combination, and the marks in them.
2. The TET gate - CTET or your state's TET, in the right paper, for the right level.
3. The recruitment gate - a separate competitive exam run by a state commission or board, where you are ranked against everyone else who cleared the first two gates.
4. The verification gate - documents, category certificates, medicals and rosters. A large share of candidates who clear gate three lose the seat here.

Tamil Nadu publishes the arithmetic that makes this concrete. Its Teachers Recruitment Board reports that since 2012, 41,52,752 candidates have appeared across its TET papers and 3,20,014 have passed. As on 15 April 2026, the state had 1,12,188 TET Paper I qualified candidates and 1,69,796 Paper II qualified candidates who had passed the eligibility test but had not been selected for a post. That is the real shape of the competition: the eligibility test is not the bottleneck. The recruitment exam is.

> The TET pass rate is also not the disaster people assume. In Tamil Nadu's 2025 TET, 49.86% of Paper I candidates passed (46,083 of 92,417) and 31.92% of Paper II candidates passed (1,05,946 of 3,31,900). Passing is achievable. Getting ranked high enough to be appointed is the hard part.

So this book is organised around the gates, not around the syllabus. Chapters 1 to 7 settle whether you are eligible at all, because ineligible applications are the single most common way people lose a year. Chapters 8 to 11 handle the TET layer and the one change - lifetime validity - that most candidates still do not know about. Chapters 12 to 20 are about the recruitment exams that are live in the 2026-27 cycle and how to prepare for them. Chapters 21 to 24 cover what happens after the exam, including the document traps that quietly disqualify people.

2. Four kinds of employer, four different doors

There is no single national teacher recruitment exam. Depending on who you want to work for, you are applying through a completely different machine, with different eligibility, different papers and different pay. Pick your door before you buy another test series.

Employer	Who runs recruitment	How it works
State government and local body schools	State commission or board - for example BPSC in Bihar, UPESSC in Uttar Pradesh, the Teachers Recruitment Board in Tamil Nadu, the School Education Department in Andhra Pradesh	State TET, then a separate state recruitment test, then document verification and posting
Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan (KVS)	KVS, under the Ministry of Education	National-level written exam plus interview. CTET Paper I for PRT, Paper II for TGT
Navodaya Vidyalaya Samiti (NVS)	NVS, under the Ministry of Education	Same pattern as KVS, usually advertised together with it
Government-aided private schools	State commission, on requisition from the schools	The school is the appointing authority, but the state runs the selection exam. Uttar Pradesh's current 17,735-post TGT drive is this route

Why the aided-school route matters more than people think

Aided schools are privately managed but government funded, and in several states their teacher posts are filled through the same state commission that fills government posts. The pay is on the state pay matrix. In Uttar Pradesh, the 17,735 posts advertised on 23 October 2026 are all in non-government aided secondary schools, and the advertised pay is Pay Matrix Level 7, Rs.44,900 to Rs.1,42,400 a month.

The catch is that reservation is applied school by school rather than across the whole state, because each aided school is treated as a single unit with its own sanctioned strength. UPESSC had to issue a public clarification on 27 October 2026 after social media claims that the roster had been calculated wrongly. Read the vacancy table in the notification, not the forwarded message.

The central schools are a different animal

KVS and NVS pay on the central pay matrix, recruit nationally, and require CTET in a way that is non-negotiable. Their published recruitment rules for the 2026-27 cycle set Primary Teacher at Pay Level 6 (Rs.35,400 to Rs.1,12,400) with an upper age limit of 30, Trained Graduate Teacher at Level 7 (Rs.44,900 to Rs.1,42,400) with an age limit of 35, and Post Graduate Teacher at Level 8 (Rs.47,600 to Rs.1,51,100) with an age limit of 40.

Two details matter. First, PGT posts do not require CTET - the requirement is a master's degree in the subject with 50%, plus B.Ed with 50%. Second, PRT and TGT posts do require it, and reserved-category candidates get up to a 5% relaxation in the CTET qualifying marks. Also note that a graduate with B.Ed can be appointed as a KVS PRT only if they complete an NCTE-recognised six-month bridge course in elementary education within two years of appointment. That is a real condition, written into the recruitment rules, and it catches people who assume a B.Ed alone makes them a primary teacher.

3. What is actually open in the 2026-27 cycle

Three large state drives were live or about to open as this book was written. All dates below are from the official notifications; all of them can be extended or amended, so verify before you pay a fee.

Drive	Posts	Where it stands	Source to verify
Bihar - BPSC TRE 4.0 (Advt 15/2026, dated 22 September 2026)	33,320	Applications open; fee payment to 2 November 2026, application to 3 November 2026. Exam date not yet notified	bpsc.bihar.gov.in and bpsconline.bihar.gov.in
Uttar Pradesh - UPESSC Assistant Teacher (TGT) 2026 (Advt 07/2026, published 23 October 2026)	17,735	Registration from 24 October 2026; fee to 23 November 2026; correction to 26 November 2026; exam 23-24 December 2026	upessc.up.gov.in
Andhra Pradesh - DSC-2026 / APTRT-2026 (Brief Notification No. 1, dated 13 October 2026)	2,111 notified in the brief notification, plus 260 in welfare and model school societies	Detailed notification due on or before 3 November 2026; computer-based test; media reports put the full Mega DSC at 16,347 posts	tet2dsc.apcfss.in and cse.ap.gov.in

Read that Andhra Pradesh row carefully, because it is a live lesson in how to read notifications. The brief notification of 13 October 2026 notified 2,111 tentative posts - 906 School Assistant and 1,205 Secondary Grade Teacher - in government, Zilla Parishad, Mandal Parishad and municipal schools. A separate government order the same day cleared 260 posts of principals, PGTs, TGTs, physical directors and PETs in welfare societies and model schools. Press coverage of the same event reported a total of 16,347 teaching positions across all categories.

All three numbers can be true at once: the brief notification covers one slice, the order covers another, and the media figure is the whole Mega DSC envelope across departments. The only number that matters for your application is the one in the detailed notification for the post you are applying to. It is due by 3 November 2026.

> A rule that will save you money: never trust a post count you saw on a news site or a Telegram channel. Open the notification PDF, find the vacancy table for your subject and category, and count the row yourself. Post counts get revised upward and downward, and the revision is always published as a corrigendum on the official site.

The rest of the year

Beyond these three, the pattern to watch is that state TETs and state recruitment tests run in their own cycles, and they do not coordinate with each other. Bihar ran TRE 3.0 before TRE 4.0; Tamil Nadu runs a TET and then a separate recruitment exam, a two-step structure the state formalised by government order in 2018; Himachal Pradesh ran a June 2026 TET across ten categories; Andhra Pradesh ran APTET in June 2026 with four papers. If your state is quiet this month, it is almost certainly not quiet for the whole year.

4. The four teaching levels, and what each one demands

Almost every rejection at the eligibility stage comes from applying at the wrong level. The levels are not interchangeable, and a B.Ed does not let you teach Class 1.

Level	Classes	What NCTE asks for	Which TET paper
Primary / PRT / SGT / JBT	1 to 5	Senior secondary with 50% plus a two-year D.El.Ed, or senior secondary with 50% plus a four-year B.El.Ed. Graduation plus two-year D.El.Ed also qualifies	CTET Paper I or state TET Paper I
Upper primary / TGT	6 to 8	Graduation with 50% plus B.Ed, or graduation plus two-year D.El.Ed, or 10+2 with 50% plus four-year B.El.Ed or B.A.Ed / B.Sc.Ed	CTET Paper II or state TET Paper II
Secondary	9 to 10	Graduation or post-graduation in the teaching subject with 50%, plus B.Ed or B.Ed (Special Education)	State secondary TET (in Bihar, STET Paper I)
Senior secondary / PGT	11 to 12	Post-graduation in the subject with 50%, plus B.Ed; or an integrated four-year B.A.Ed / B.Sc.Ed	State senior secondary TET (in Bihar, STET Paper II)
Special educator	varies	NCTE and Rehabilitation Council of India recognised qualification, plus a valid RCI CRR number	Special education TET paper
Physical education teacher	varies	B.P.Ed or equivalent from an NCTE-recognised institution	Not required in Andhra Pradesh for PET and SA (Physical Education)

Two things in that table are worth pausing on.

First, at primary level a B.Ed is not a substitute for a D.El.Ed. NCTE's own regulations say it directly: for appointment to primary classes, a basic teachers' training programme of two years is required, and a B.Ed is not a substitute for it. There is a narrow graduate-plus-B.Ed route into primary teaching in some systems - KVS allows it with a six-month bridge course - but it is an exception written into specific recruitment rules, not a general right.

Second, secondary and senior secondary teaching in most states is subject-specific in a way that upper primary is not. Bihar requires STET Paper I in the relevant subject for Classes 9 to 10 and STET Paper II for Classes 11 to 12, not CTET. Uttar Pradesh's TGT drive lists 17 subjects with separate subject-combination rules, and it has now added Computer as a TGT subject.

5. Marks, subject combinations, and the equivalence trap

The 50% rule is where careful candidates lose seats. It is not one rule; it is at least four, and each state writes its own version.

- Uttar Pradesh TGT 2026 requires 50% in graduation in the relevant subject, or 45% in post-graduation in that subject, plus B.Ed.
- KVS and NVS require 50% in the concerned subject and 50% in aggregate, plus B.Ed with 50%.
- Bihar's TRE 4.0 notification carries its own subject-wise qualification table, with separate combinations for Mathematics and Science, Social Science, languages, and vocational subjects.
- Himachal Pradesh's June 2026 TET prospectus notes that the minimum percentage in graduation does not apply to candidates who had already taken admission to B.Ed or B.El.Ed before 29 July 2011.

That last line is not a quirk. It is the grandfathering clause in the 2011 NCTE notification, and it is the reason a candidate who finished a B.Ed in 2010 with 46% in graduation can be eligible where a 2020 graduate with 46% is not. If you are near a percentage boundary, read the exact clause in your state's notification before

you assume you are out.

The equivalence trap: distance and open-university degrees

Andhra Pradesh states the rule in language that every candidate should read once. Degrees obtained through open universities or distance mode must be recognised by the University Grants Commission, AICTE or the Distance Education Bureau as applicable. A university established under a state act may operate only within its territorial jurisdiction. And the burden of proving recognition rests on the candidate - if you cannot prove it, the certificate is not counted at all.

In practice this means three checks before you apply anywhere: is my university UGC-recognised, is my B.Ed or D.El.Ed from an NCTE-recognised institution, and was my degree taken within the jurisdiction my university was allowed to operate in. For special education qualifications, add a fourth: is the course RCI-recognised, and do I hold a valid CRR number.

> NCTE maintains a public list of recognised teacher education institutions and courses. If your B.Ed college is not on it, no state recruitment exam will rescue you later, and no amount of marks will. Check it now, before you build a year around it.

6. Age: the rule that quietly ends careers

Age limits in teacher recruitment are computed against a stated cut-off date, and the cut-off differs by state and by year. Getting this wrong is not correctable after you submit.

State / employer	Cut-off basis	Limits
Bihar - TRE 4.0	Recruiting year: minimum age as on 1 January of the recruiting year, maximum as on 1 July	18 years minimum for Classes 1-5 and 6-8; 21 for Classes 9-10 and 11-12. Maximum 37 for unreserved male, 40 for unreserved female and for BC/EBC, 42 for SC/ST
Uttar Pradesh - TGT 2026	As on 1 July 2026	21 to 62 years
KVS / NVS	Closing date for online application	PRT 30, TGT 35, PGT 40. Five-year relaxation for serving KVS employees, plus statutory category relaxations
Himachal Pradesh - TET	Not applicable at the TET stage	No upper age limit to sit the TET; age is applied by the appointing authority at appointment

Notice the shape of it. Bihar's upper limit of 37 for an unreserved male candidate is tighter than most people expect, and it is measured against a date fixed in the notification, not against the day you apply. Uttar Pradesh's 62-year ceiling is unusually generous and reflects a backlog-clearing drive in aided schools. Himachal's TET has no upper age limit at all, because the TET is an eligibility certificate and the state applies age at the point of appointment.

Two practical consequences. If you are within two years of an age ceiling in a state you want, apply this cycle even if you feel underprepared - the ceiling does not wait for your preparation. And if you are over the ceiling in your own state, check the states and central systems where you are still inside it, because the TET you already hold travels with you.

7. Your eligibility, on one page

Fill this in once, honestly, and keep it. Every application form you fill this year will ask for the same information, and the answer should not change between forms.

Check	Your answer	Why it matters
Highest degree, subject, university, year, percentage		Determines which levels and subjects you may apply for
Teacher training qualification, institution, NCTE recognition		B.Ed for upper primary and above; D.El.Ed for primary
Graduation percentage in the teaching subject		Most states set 50% here, with a 45% post-graduation alternative
TET held: which exam, which paper, year, marks		Paper I covers Classes 1-5, Paper II covers 6-8, STET for 9-12 in Bihar
TET validity		Lifetime since 2021, unless a state notifies otherwise
Date of birth and age as on 1 January and 1 July 2027		Age ceilings are measured against notification dates
Category and certificate validity date		OBC non-creamy-layer and EWS certificates expire; SC/ST do not
Domicile state		Decides which state reservation you can claim, and district cadre in AP
RCI CRR number, if special education		Mandatory for special educator posts
Any prior government service, and whether an NOC is needed		In-service candidates must inform or obtain an NOC

One column of that table is worth a second look: the TET row. Candidates routinely hold a TET they cannot use, because they passed Paper I and are applying for a Class 6-8 post, or they passed a state TET in a state where the recruitment body only accepts its own. Chapter 11 sets out which certificate opens which door.

8. What a TET actually is

The Teacher Eligibility Test exists because of one section of one act. Section 23(1) of the RTE Act, 2009 requires the National Council for Teacher Education to prescribe minimum qualifications for teachers, and NCTE's notifications of 23 August 2010 and 29 July 2011 made passing a TET one of those qualifications. The Ministry of Education handed the central version - the CTET - to the CBSE to conduct.

There are therefore two families of TET, and they are not the same certificate.

	Central TET (CTET)	State TET
Who conducts it	CBSE, under the Ministry of Education	The state government's designated agency - a board, a commission, or the education department
Who accepts it	KVS, NVS, and any state or school that chooses to accept it	That state's own schools; some states accept CTET in its place, some do not
Papers	Paper I for Classes 1-5, Paper II for Classes 6-8	Usually the same two papers, plus separate secondary and senior secondary papers where the state has them
Structure	150 questions, 150 marks, 150 minutes	Usually 150 questions and 150 marks, but not always - always read the bulletin
Frequency	Twice a year - February and September editions in 2026	Set by the state; often annual or less frequent

The most useful sentence in this chapter: for a state government job, the state TET is normally the one that counts, and a CTET is a substitute only where that state's rules say so. Bihar is a good example of a state that explicitly accepts both - its TRE 4.0 notification allows CTET Paper I or BTET Paper I for Classes 1-5, and CTET Paper II or BTET Paper II for Classes 6-8 - but requires the state's own STET for Classes 9-12.

Andhra Pradesh is a good example of a state that accepts both but weights them. APTET or CTET is required for School Assistant, Secondary Grade Teacher and the special education posts, and either score is used for the 20% TET weightage in selection.

Tamil Nadu is a good example of a state that keeps its own gate. Its Teachers Recruitment Board is the designated nodal agency for the TNTET, and passing TNTET only qualifies you to sit the separate recruitment examination. The state made that two-step structure explicit by government order in 2018.

9. Your TET certificate is valid for life - most people still do not know

Until 2021, a TET certificate was valid for seven years. That is no longer true, and the change is retrospective, which means certificates that had already expired were revived.

NCTE wrote to all state education secretaries on 9 June 2021, with the approval of the Ministry of Education, replacing the seven-year clause in its 2011 TET guidelines with this: the validity period of a TET qualifying certificate for appointment, unless otherwise notified by the appropriate government, would remain valid for life. The change applies with retrospective effect from 11 February 2011, and states were told to revalidate or reissue certificates to candidates whose seven years had already lapsed.

The Press Information Bureau announced the same change on 3 June 2021. The CBSE's CTET FAQ confirms it for CTET, noting the notice dated 21 June 2021. Tamil Nadu implemented it by government order in August 2021. Himachal Pradesh's June 2026 TET prospectus states it plainly: the validity period of the HP TET qualifying certificate for appointment is lifetime for all categories, there is no restriction on the number of attempts, and a person who has qualified may appear again to improve their score.

What this changes for you

- If you passed a TET in 2014 or 2018 and assumed it had lapsed, check with the issuing board. It is very likely still valid, and in some states you can get it reissued.
- There is no attempt limit on CTET. If your score is mediocre and your state weights TET marks in selection, sitting again to improve is rational, not desperate.
- Because the certificate does not expire, the TET is a one-time investment and the recruitment exam is the recurring one. Budget your study time accordingly.
- Check one thing before you rely on this: a few states have notified their own conditions. The NCTE clause says "unless otherwise notified by the appropriate government", and that escape hatch is real. The state's own TET bulletin is the final word for that state.

10. Pass marks are set by states, not by NCTE

There is no national pass mark for a TET. NCTE sets a floor of 60%, and states have layered category relaxations on top of it in their own ways. This table is built from four official documents and shows how much the numbers move.

Exam	Total	Unreserved	Middle categories	Reserved / PwD
APTET (Andhra Pradesh), June 2026	150	OC and EWS: 90 (60%)	BC: 75 (50%)	SC, ST, PwBD, ex-servicemen: 60 (40%)
TNTET (Tamil Nadu), revised by G.O. dated 28 January 2026	150	OC: 90	BC, BC(M), MBC/DNC: 75	SC, SC(A), ST: 60; PwD: 60
HP TET (Himachal Pradesh), June 2026	150	60% overall	5% relaxation for SC/ST/OBC/PHH	Same 5% relaxation; no negative marking in the paper
Bihar - CTET / BTET scores accepted for TRE 4.0	150	General: 60%	BC, EBC and general-category women: 55%	SC/ST and PwD: 50%

Two observations that change how you prepare. Andhra Pradesh and Tamil Nadu both let a reserved-category candidate qualify at 60 out of 150, which is 40%. That is a very different paper from the one an unreserved candidate is sitting. And Himachal Pradesh's TET has no negative marking, so the exam technique that works in Bihar - where a blank answer is penalised - is actively wrong in Himachal.

> Bihar's slab is worth understanding because it is easy to misread. For CTET and BTET candidates, the state applies its own BTET 2017 thresholds: 60% for general, 55% for BC, EBC and general-category women, 50% for SC/ST and PwD. A candidate from outside Bihar is assessed as a general-category candidate.

11. Which TET opens which door

This is the table to check before you spend money on a form. Getting it wrong means your application is rejected at verification, months later, after you have paid and travelled.

You want	What most states require	What the central schools require
Classes 1-5 in a state school	State TET Paper I; CTET Paper I where the state accepts it	CTET Paper I
Classes 6-8 in a state school	State TET Paper II; CTET Paper II where accepted	CTET Paper II
Classes 9-10 in a state school	The state's secondary TET in the relevant subject (STET Paper I in Bihar)	KVS/NVS TGT posts are the closest equivalent and use CTET Paper II
Classes 11-12 in a state school	The state's senior secondary TET in the relevant subject (STET Paper II in Bihar)	KVS/NVS PGT posts do not require CTET at all
Special educator posts	Special education TET paper, plus RCI registration and a valid CRR number	CTET Paper I or II as applicable, plus RCI registration
Physical education teacher	State rules; Andhra Pradesh does not require TET for PET or SA (Physical Education)	Not a CTET post

The part everyone forgets: TET marks can carry real weight

In Andhra Pradesh, selection for School Assistant, Secondary Grade Teacher, TGT (Special Education) and SGT (Special Education) is out of 100 marks - 80 from the recruitment test and 20 from the APTET or CTET score. Physical education posts are the exception: 100 marks from the written test alone, with no TET weightage.

That is a fifth of your final rank decided before you sit the recruitment exam. A candidate with 120 out of 150 in APTET takes 16 of the 20 available marks. A candidate with 90 takes 12. Four marks of final rank is a large gap in a state where a few marks separate a posting from a waiting list.

Bihar runs the opposite design: TET is a pass-or-fail gate and plays no part in the merit list, which is built from the recruitment exam alone. Uttar Pradesh sits in between - TET is mandatory but not scored, and candidates without it were allowed to apply for the 2026 TGT drive provided they obtain a valid certificate by 30 June 2027.

So the value of a high TET score depends entirely on your state. If you are in Andhra Pradesh, treat APTET as a scored paper. If you are in Bihar, treat it as a switch you flip once and forget.

12. Bihar TRE 4.0, decoded

This is the largest live teacher recruitment in the country right now: 33,320 posts under Advertisement No. 15/2026, dated 22 September 2026, which cancelled and replaced the earlier Advertisement No. 14/2026 of 18 August 2026. The original 32,388 posts grew by 932 - 493 in Classes 9-10 and 439 in Classes 11-12 - after a revised requisition from the Education Department.

Item	Detail
Posts	33,320 across Classes 1-5, 6-8, 9-10 and 11-12, plus special school teacher and principal posts
Application window	Opened 25 September 2026. Extended: fee payment to 2 November 2026, online application to 3 November 2026
Fee	Rs.100 per class-level category. Applying for Classes 1-5 and 6-8 means two fees
Biometric fee	Rs.200 where the candidate does not provide a valid Aadhaar number
Paper	150 objective questions, 150 marks, 2 hours 30 minutes, OMR-based
Structure	Part I language 30 marks (qualifying, minimum 30%), Part II general studies 40 marks, Part III concerned subject 80 marks. For Classes 1-5, Part II carries 120 marks and there is no subject part
Merit	Built from Part II plus Part III (120 marks). The language part is qualifying only and does not add to merit
Negative marking	One-third mark deducted for a wrong answer - and for a blank one
Age	18 minimum for Classes 1-5 and 6-8; 21 for Classes 9-10 and 11-12. Maximum 37 unreserved male, 40 unreserved female and BC/EBC, 42 SC/ST
Eligibility test	CTET or BTET Paper I for Classes 1-5, Paper II for 6-8, STET Paper I for 9-10, STET Paper II for 11-12
Portal	bpsc.bihar.gov.in, with applications through bpsconline.bihar.gov.in

The option E trap

Bihar made a change this cycle that has no equivalent in most exams: the OMR sheet now carries a fifth option. If you do not want to answer a question, you must fill the fifth bubble to say so. Leave a question completely blank and one-third of a mark is deducted anyway.

This inverts the usual guessing advice. In an exam where a blank costs you one-third of a mark and a wrong answer costs you the same one-third, guessing is free in expectation as long as you can eliminate one option. On a four-option question with one eliminated, your expected gain from guessing is zero - and on any question where you can eliminate two, guessing is clearly profitable.

The practical rule for Bihar: never leave a bubble empty. If you know the answer, mark it. If you can eliminate anything, guess. If you truly cannot, fill option E - which at least signals a deliberate non-answer rather than an incomplete sheet.

The language part is a pass-fail switch worth 30% of the paper's time

Part I is 30 marks of language and you need 30% of it, which is 9 marks, to qualify. Those 30 marks do not enter your merit total. That creates a specific risk: candidates who chase subject marks and neglect the language section can score 130 out of 150 overall and still be disqualified for scoring 8 in Part I.

Treat Part I as a fixed 9 marks you must bank, then ignore it. In the exam, attempt the language section first, confirm you are comfortably past 9, and spend the rest of your time where merit is actually built.

> A detail that rescues some candidates: applicants who have the teaching qualification but have not yet cleared STET may apply for the secondary and senior secondary levels, provided they clear STET 2026 before the preliminary test, by submitting a self-declaration form with their application. Candidates who completed the D.El.Ed session in 2024-2026 may also apply using the web copy of their marksheet. Both are narrow windows - read the exact wording in the notification.

13. Uttar Pradesh TGT 2026, decoded

UPESSC published Advertisement No. 07/2026 on 23 October 2026 for 17,735 Assistant Teacher (Trained Graduate Scale) posts in non-government aided secondary schools - 16,193 in boys' schools and 1,542 in girls' schools - covering Classes 6 to 10 across 17 subjects.

Item	Detail
Posts	17,735. Also advertised in the same drive: 1,475 principal posts and 1,172 headmaster posts
Registration	One Time Registration is mandatory. Registration from 24 October 2026; fee payment to 23 November 2026; corrections to 26 November 2026
Exam	23 and 24 December 2026
Paper	120 objective questions, 360 marks, two hours. 30 questions on general knowledge, 90 on the concerned subject
Fee	Rs.1,000 for General, OBC and EWS; Rs.500 for SC/ST; Rs.300 for PwD
Age	21 to 62 years as on 1 July 2026
Pay	Pay Matrix Level 7, Rs.44,900 to Rs.1,42,400
Eligibility	Graduate with 50% in the relevant subject, or postgraduate with 45%, plus B.Ed or an equivalent L.T. or B.T. qualification from a recognised university, plus upper primary TET
TET timing	Candidates without a valid TET could apply, provided they obtain one by 30 June 2027. Without it by that date, no appointment

360 marks from 120 questions changes the arithmetic

Three marks per question, two hours, 120 questions. That is one question per minute with time to spare, and it means each question is worth a lot. The paper is 25% general knowledge and 75% subject content - so your subject is where the marks are, and general knowledge is where they are lost cheaply.

Note what is absent: there is no separate pedagogy paper. Upper primary TET is an eligibility condition, not a section of this exam. Candidates who prepare pedagogy heavily because they are used to CTET-style papers will find they have prepared the wrong thing.

The subject map tells you where the queue is

Subject	Posts	Subject	Posts
Hindi	2,791	Sanskrit	1,289

Subject	Posts	Subject	Posts
English	2,517	Physical education	849
Science	2,493	Home science	798
Social science	2,482	Drawing	775
Mathematics	2,349	Biology	660

The long tail is thin: 248 posts in agriculture, 134 in commerce, 103 in Urdu, 87 in vocal music, 79 in drawing and painting, 60 in instrumental music, 21 in sewing. Hindi, English, Science, Social Science and Mathematics together account for about 70% of the posts.

This creates a genuine strategic choice. A large subject has many posts and many competitors; a small subject has few posts and very few competitors. Neither is automatically better, but the small subject is only worth entering if your degree genuinely qualifies you for it - the subject-combination rules are strict, and a wrong combination is a rejection at verification.

14. Andhra Pradesh DSC-2026, decoded

Andhra Pradesh runs teacher recruitment as a two-part system that is easier to understand than most: a state TET, and then a District Selection Committee test that combines with it.

Item	Detail
Notifications	Brief Notification No. 1/DSC-2026/APTRT-2026 dated 13 October 2026, plus G.O.Ms.No.30 dated 13 October 2026 for welfare society and model school posts
Posts notified in the brief notification	2,111 tentative - 906 School Assistant and 1,205 Secondary Grade Teacher - in government, Zilla Parishad, Mandal Parishad, municipal and municipal corporation schools
Additional posts	260 posts of principals, PGTs, TGTs, physical directors and PETs in welfare societies and AP Model Schools
Next step	Detailed notification with post-wise and category-wise vacancies, qualifications and dates on or before 3 November 2026
Mode	Computer-based test, objective
Selection	80% recruitment test plus 20% APTET or CTET score, for School Assistant, SGT and the special education posts. Physical education posts are 100% written test, with no TET
District cadre	Selection is valid only for the district applied to, and local reservation follows the Presidential Order under Article 371-D
Portal	tet2dsc.apcfss.in and cse.ap.gov.in

What the SGT paper looks like

The Secondary Grade Teacher paper is 160 questions carrying 80 marks in two and a half hours, split as general knowledge and current affairs 8 marks, perspectives in education 4, educational psychology 8, language I content and methodology 12, English content and methodology 12, mathematics 12, science 12, and social studies 12. The School Assistant paper is also 160 questions and 80 marks, with a much heavier subject component: 40 marks of subject content and 20 of subject methodology.

Read the weightings as instructions. In SGT, no single section dominates and every subject of the elementary curriculum counts equally - which rewards a broad, even preparation and punishes the candidate who only revises their favourite subject. In School Assistant, half the paper is your subject, so depth wins.

The district dimension is unique to Andhra Pradesh and easy to miss. You are competing within a district roster, not statewide, so the district you choose changes your competition. Applying to a district with many vacancies and few local candidates is a legitimate strategy - provided you can meet the local status requirements under the Presidential Order.

15. Reading any state notification in twenty minutes

Notifications run to 40 pages of dense text, and 80% of it does not apply to you. Extract these twelve items in order, write them on one page, and keep that page for every form you fill.

1. The advertisement number and date, and whether it cancels an earlier advertisement. Bihar's TRE 4.0 replaced an earlier advertisement entirely, which meant people who had applied under the old one had to apply again.
2. The exact post count for your subject, category and school type - from the vacancy table, not the summary paragraph.
3. The last date for fee payment, the last date for application, and the correction window. They are three different dates and the fee date usually comes first.
4. The fee for your category, and whether it is charged per level or per subject.
5. The paper structure: questions, marks, duration, and whether marking is negative.
6. Whether any section is qualifying rather than scored. This single line changes your exam strategy more than any other.
7. The age band, the cut-off date used to compute it, and your category's relaxation.
8. The exact educational qualification clause for your subject, including the percentage and whether a post-graduate alternative exists.
9. The TET requirement: which exam, which paper, and whether the state accepts a central TET.
10. Whether a candidate without the TET may apply conditionally, and by what date the certificate must be produced.
11. The document list for verification, and any certificate validity conditions attached to it.
12. The official portal name and the helpline. Note it in full - lookalike portals that charge a service fee are common during large drives.

> A habit worth adopting: before reading any notification, open the corrigendum section of the same website. Large drives publish several amendments within weeks - vacancy revisions, date extensions, clarification notices. Reading only the original notification is how candidates miss a changed exam date.

16. Choosing your level and subject without wasting a cycle

Most candidates apply where their degree points, then discover three months later that a different level would have given them a better chance. Four questions settle it.

Are you eligible at more than one level?

A candidate with a B.A. in English, a B.Ed and both TET papers can apply for upper primary English, secondary English and, in some states, primary. Each level is a separate competition with a separate vacancy pool. Applying at two levels where the rules allow it is not indecision; it is doubling your entry tickets

for a second application fee.

Does your subject combination actually match?

Uttar Pradesh's TGT drive lists 17 subjects, each with its own combination rule, and the state has added Computer as a TGT subject. Bihar's notification sets out combinations for Mathematics and Science together, for Social Science as any two of a listed set of subjects, and separately for each language. The rule to internalise: your degree subjects must match the teaching subject in the way the notification specifies - not approximately, and not because the subjects are related.

Is the vacancy pool deep enough to survive a bad paper?

In Uttar Pradesh, Hindi has 2,791 posts and sewing has 21. In a 21-post pool, a single mark can move you from a post to a waiting list. In a 2,791-post pool there is room for ordinary variance. If your subject is thin, plan for a higher score than feels reasonable.

Can you meet the age and document conditions for long enough?

An eligibility that expires - an OBC non-creamy-layer certificate, an EWS certificate, a TET that a particular state does not accept - is worse than no eligibility, because you will build a year around it and lose it at verification. Check the certificate validity date against the likely date of document verification, not against today.

17. What these papers actually test

Across the three live drives, the content is more consistent than the formats suggest. Four things recur.

- Subject content at school level, not competitive-exam level. Andhra Pradesh's syllabus documents run to the SCERT curriculum for the classes you would teach. Bihar's subject part is set at NCERT or Bihar Board standard for that level. Preparing at M.A. depth is wasted effort; preparing at the depth of the textbook you will teach from is exactly right.
- Perspectives in education and educational psychology, in modest quantities. Andhra Pradesh gives 4 marks to perspectives and 8 to educational psychology in the SGT paper. These are cheap marks - a fixed, learnable body of content - and most candidates under-prepare them relative to their return.
- General knowledge and current affairs, capped and predictable. 30 of 120 questions in UP, 8 of 80 marks in AP SGT, 40 of 150 in Bihar's Part II. This is the section where a candidate with a disciplined daily habit beats a candidate with more subject knowledge.
- Language competence, which is either qualifying or embedded. Bihar makes it a qualifying 30 marks. UP and AP fold language into the paper. Either way, weak language ability caps your score.

What is not tested, in any of these three: research methodology, advanced pedagogy theory, or knowledge of education policy documents. If your preparation is built around NEP commentary and theoretical frameworks, you are preparing for an interview you have not been called to.

18. Negative marking: the arithmetic nobody does

Bihar's paper deducts one-third of a mark for a wrong answer and one-third for a blank. Uttar Pradesh's paper, as advertised, is a straight three marks per question. Andhra Pradesh's computer-based test is 80

marks from 160 questions. These are three different games and they reward three different behaviours.

Bihar: guess when you can eliminate anything

With four options and a one-third penalty, a random guess from four has an expected value of zero: one-quarter chance of plus one, three-quarters chance of minus one-third. Eliminate one option and the expected value turns positive. Eliminate two and it doubles again. Since a blank also costs one-third, the correct default is always to mark something.

The only rational exception is a question where all four options look equally plausible and you have no information at all - and even then, filling option E and guessing produce the same expected score, so guess anyway for the chance of the upside.

Uttar Pradesh: attempt everything

Three marks per question with no stated penalty means every question you leave blank is three marks you declined. With 120 questions in two hours, the risk is not the penalty - it is spending four minutes on a question worth three marks and losing three others.

Set a hard cap: 60 seconds per question on the first pass, mark and move. Come back to the difficult ones only after the sheet is full.

Andhra Pradesh: computer-based, so plan the interface

A computer-based test lets you flag questions and return, which changes strategy - you can afford a two-pass approach. The marks are unusually compressed: 160 questions carrying 80 marks, so each question is half a mark, and small careless errors accumulate slowly rather than dramatically. The bigger risk is the interface itself. Use the official mock test before exam day; APTET and DSC both provide one.

25. Seven myths, checked against the documents

Each of these is repeated confidently in coaching groups and each one is contradicted by an official document. If you believe only one thing from this book, believe these.

1. "My TET expired after seven years"

It did not. NCTE's letter of 9 June 2021 replaced the seven-year clause with lifetime validity, with retrospective effect from 11 February 2011, and directed states to revalidate or reissue certificates that had lapsed. Tamil Nadu implemented it by government order in 2021; Himachal Pradesh's 2026 TET prospectus states it as current policy. Check your issuing board if you passed years ago - the certificate is probably still good.

2. "A B.Ed lets me teach any class"

It does not. NCTE's regulations say that for primary classes a two-year basic teachers' training programme is required and a B.Ed is not a substitute for it. KVS does allow a graduate with B.Ed into a PRT post, but only with an NCTE-recognised six-month bridge course in elementary education completed within two years of appointment - an exception written into those recruitment rules, not a general rule.

3. "Qualifying CTET means I am eligible for a job"

The CBSE says the opposite in its own FAQ: qualifying CTET "would not confer a right on any person for recruitment/employment". Andhra Pradesh's APTET notification carries the same warning. A TET is one

essential qualification among several, and appointment is a separate decision made by a separate body.

4. "Any state's TET works in every state"

Only where that state's rules say so. Bihar accepts CTET or BTET for Classes 1-8 but requires its own STET for Classes 9-12. Andhra Pradesh accepts APTET or CTET. Tamil Nadu runs its own TET and then a separate recruitment exam. The acceptance rule is in the recruitment notification, and it is the first thing to check when you consider applying outside your home state.

5. "The vacancy number in the news is the vacancy number"

Andhra Pradesh's October 2026 drive was reported as 16,347 posts. The brief notification of 13 October 2026 notified 2,111 posts across two categories; a separate government order cleared 260 posts in welfare societies and model schools. All three are true statements about different slices. In Bihar, the count moved from 32,388 to 33,320 within weeks of the advertisement. Count the row in the vacancy table for your subject and category.

6. "I will fill the form later, it is only a fee"

The fee is not trivial and the dates are unforgiving. Bihar charges Rs.100 per class-level category, plus Rs.200 biometric if you do not provide Aadhaar. Uttar Pradesh charges Rs.1,000 for General, OBC and EWS candidates. APTET charges Rs.1,000 per paper, and candidates with both D.El.Ed and B.Ed wanting all four papers pay four times. Fee deadlines also usually fall before application deadlines - in Bihar, 2 November against 3 November 2026.

7. "Negative marking means I should leave questions blank"

Not in Bihar. TRE 4.0 deducts one-third of a mark for a wrong answer and one-third for a blank answer, and the OMR sheet carries a fifth option that you must fill to record a deliberate non-answer. Leaving a bubble empty gains you nothing and loses the same amount as guessing wrong. In Uttar Pradesh's TGT paper, as advertised, there is no penalty at all - every blank is simply three marks declined.

26. The syllabus, section by section

State papers look different from each other, but they draw on the same five blocks. Prepare them once and you can sit several states' exams in the same year without starting over.

Block 1: language

Two parts. Comprehension - unseen passages with questions on inference, vocabulary and tone. And grammar plus language pedagogy - sentence correction, idioms, and how language is taught at the level you are applying for. Bihar makes this a qualifying section of 30 marks with a 30% floor, so the block can disqualify you even when your subject score is strong. Do not leave it to the last week.

Block 2: general knowledge and current affairs

Static general knowledge plus the last twelve months. In education exams the current-affairs portion leans heavily on education: new schemes, commissions and committees, examination reforms, national policy developments, sports and awards. Read one source daily and keep a single running document. The marks are capped - 30 of 120 questions in Uttar Pradesh, 8 of 80 marks in Andhra Pradesh's SGT paper, 40 of 150 in Bihar - so the return on over-investing here is poor. Consistency beats depth.

Block 3: perspectives in education

The policy and legal frame: the Right to Education Act and what it guarantees, the constitutional provisions on education, the National Curriculum Framework documents, the major education commissions and their recommendations, and the current national education policy. In Andhra Pradesh this is a named section - 4 marks in the SGT paper, 5 in the School Assistant paper. Small, finite, and almost entirely learnable from one good summary.

Block 4: educational psychology

The block most candidates under-prepare relative to its return. Child development - physical, cognitive, social and emotional, stage by stage. Learning theories and their classroom implications. Intelligence and its measurement. Motivation. Individual differences, inclusive education, learning difficulties and disabilities. Assessment and evaluation, including the difference between formative and summative. Andhra Pradesh gives this 8 marks in the SGT paper and 5 in the School Assistant paper. In Bihar it sits inside the general studies part, which is 40 of the 150 marks and half of your merit total.

Block 5: subject content and its methodology

The largest block everywhere. Two rules govern it. First, prepare at the depth of the school textbook for the classes you will teach, not at post-graduate depth - Andhra Pradesh's syllabus documents are built on the state SCERT curriculum, and Bihar's subject part is set at NCERT or Bihar Board standard for that level. Second, expect methodology inside the subject block: how the subject is taught, common misconceptions, and the use of teaching aids. In Andhra Pradesh's School Assistant paper, 40 marks are subject content and 20 are subject methodology.

> A useful sequencing rule: build Blocks 3 and 4 first, because they are finite and fast. Then Block 5, which takes the longest. Then Block 2 daily, in small doses. Then Block 1, in the final fortnight, because language competence decays slowly and responds quickly to practice.

27. If your state is closed: the cross-state map

Most candidates apply only where they live, and lose years to a state that advertises rarely. Three things travel with you across state lines, and three do not.

Travels with you	Does not travel
Your degree and teacher-training qualification, if from an NCTE-recognised institution	Your state's reservation - almost always requires domicile
Your TET certificate, where the receiving state accepts that TET	Your state's own TET, unless the receiving state accepts it
Your age, which may be inside a ceiling elsewhere even when it is outside at home	District-level local reservation, which in Andhra Pradesh runs on the Presidential Order under Article 371-D

The age point is the one that changes lives. Bihar's ceiling is 37 for an unreserved male candidate, 40 for an unreserved female and for BC/EBC, and 42 for SC/ST. Uttar Pradesh's TGT drive for 2026 sets the band at 21 to 62. KVS sets 30 for PRT, 35 for TGT and 40 for PGT. A candidate of 38 who is finished in Bihar is entirely eligible in Uttar Pradesh, and eligible for a PGT post in a Kendriya Vidyalaya.

Domicile is where the trade-off bites. Other-state candidates can usually apply, but they cannot claim state reservation. Bihar's notification makes this explicit for eligibility-test thresholds: a candidate from outside Bihar is assessed as a general-category candidate. In practice that means you need the general-category mark, and you compete in the unreserved pool.

A two-state strategy that works

1. Pick your home state as the primary target - it is where you can claim reservation and where a posting is practical.
2. Pick one secondary state where your age is comfortably inside the band and your subject has a deep vacancy pool. Uttar Pradesh's 17,735-post drive is the obvious candidate this cycle for anyone under 62 with a B.Ed and upper primary TET.
3. Keep one central option alive. KVS and NVS recruit nationally, need CTET, and pay on the central matrix - and their PGT posts do not require CTET at all, which opens a route for a subject specialist with a master's degree.
4. Sit the TET of any state you are seriously targeting, and keep the certificate. It is valid for life, so it is an asset that costs once and pays repeatedly.

28. Special education and physical education: the less crowded doors

Two categories inside teacher recruitment have far fewer applicants than the mainstream posts, because each requires a qualification most candidates do not hold. If you already hold one, or are choosing a specialisation, read this carefully.

Special education

The requirement is a Rehabilitation Council of India recognised qualification plus registration with RCI and a valid CRR number. Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan's rules for the 2026-27 cycle set Special Educator (TGT) at Pay Level 7 with an age limit of 35, requiring a graduation degree with 50%, an RCI-recognised B.Ed (Special Education) or equivalent, CTET Paper II, and RCI registration. Special Educator (PRT) sits at Level 6 with an age limit of 30 and requires CTET Paper I.

The CTET relaxation applies here too: up to 5% in the CTET qualifying marks for SC, ST, OBC-NCL and PwBD candidates. Note the double gate - CTET and RCI registration are both mandatory, and neither substitutes for the other.

Physical education

This is the one category where the TET can be irrelevant. Andhra Pradesh's selection rules state plainly that TET qualification is not required for School Assistant (Physical Education) or Physical Education Teacher posts, and selection for those posts is 100% written test with no TET weightage. The written test is also different in shape: 200 questions carrying 100 marks in three hours, covering general knowledge, perspectives in education, physical education pedagogy and a large content block spanning anatomy, physiology, kinesiology, sports medicine, yoga, sports training and management.

Uttar Pradesh's TGT drive carries 849 physical education posts, and the qualification route there is B.P.Ed or D.P.E. rather than B.Ed. If you hold a B.P.Ed and have been assuming you need a TET you cannot get,

check your state's rules before you give up on the category.

> The general principle behind both doors: an extra recognised qualification narrows the field faster than an extra year of general preparation widens your score. If you are early in your career and choosing a specialisation, a B.P.Ed or an RCI-recognised special education qualification changes the competition you face, not just your marks.

19. The 90-day plan

This plan assumes you work or study for something else, and can give the exam 12 to 15 hours a week. It is built backwards from a December exam, but the shape works for any date - compress or stretch the weeks, keep the order.

Weeks	Focus	What you finish by the end
1-2	Fix the target. Confirm your level, subject and state. Download the syllabus and two previous papers. Take one paper cold, untimed, to find out what you actually do not know	A written target, a score baseline, and a list of your five weakest topics
3-5	Subject content, first pass. Work through the school textbook for your subject, class by class, at the level you will teach. Do not use competitive-exam material	First pass through the full subject syllabus, with notes you can revise from
6-7	Educational psychology and perspectives in education. Learning theories, development, assessment, inclusive education	The pedagogy block learned well enough to score most of its marks
8-9	Subject content, second pass, on the topics your baseline paper showed were weakest	Your five weakest topics are no longer your weakest
10-11	Full-length mocks, one a week, timed, with the same negative-marking rules as the real paper. Review every wrong answer the same day	Four complete mocks and a written error log
12	Language and general knowledge consolidation. Daily current affairs from one source only	A stable daily habit, and no surprise in the language section
13	Final revision from your error log and your own notes. No new material. Sort out travel, admit card, ID, and the documents you will need later	Confidence, logistics done, nothing left to arrange

The two habits that do most of the work

The error log is the first. One page per mock: question number, topic, why you got it wrong, and the correct fact in one line. Most candidates plateau because they do mocks and never read them again. Candidates who improve are the ones who find that 30% of their errors come from five topics.

The second is the single-source rule for current affairs. Pick one daily source - a newspaper, a government digest, a monthly compilation - and stop collecting. The failure mode in general knowledge is not lack of material; it is having eleven sources and remembering none of them.

What not to do in the last three weeks

- Do not start a new test series. Every series has a different question style, and switching late costs more in confidence than it gains in coverage.
- Do not attempt to complete a subject syllabus you abandoned in week 3. Consolidate what you have; partial new coverage rarely converts into marks.
- Do not skip the language section because it feels easy. In Bihar it is a qualifying gate, and a qualifying gate you have not practised is a gate you can fail at 130 out of 150.

20. Practice that actually transfers

There is a difference between practice that makes you feel prepared and practice that makes you score. Four tests separate them.

Does the mock replicate the marking scheme?

A mock taken without negative marking trains you to guess freely. In Bihar, where a blank is penalised, the same habit is roughly neutral; in a paper with a penalty for wrong answers only, it is expensive. Take every mock under the exact rules of your target paper, including the penalty.

Do you review the paper or just the score?

The score tells you where you are. The review tells you why. A 40-minute review after every mock - going through every question, right or wrong - is worth more than a second mock in the same week.

Are you practising at the right depth?

For state recruitment tests, the correct depth is the school textbook of the classes you will teach. If a question requires knowledge beyond that textbook, it is either a current-affairs question or an outlier. Candidates who prepare at post-graduate depth in a school-level paper spend their time on questions that will not appear.

Have you rehearsed the exam-day mechanics?

For OMR papers: filling bubbles correctly, checking question number alignment, and the discipline of not shifting answers after a page turn. Bihar's fifth-option rule means you must also rehearse the decision of when to fill option E. For computer-based tests: the flag-and-return interface, the on-screen calculator where permitted, and the fact that scrolling and question navigation cost seconds you must budget for.

21. Document verification: the gate that rejects the qualified

Clearing the exam is a rank. Verification is a legal check, and it is where a large share of otherwise successful candidates disappear. Every item below appears in at least one of the three live notifications.

Document	The condition that trips people
Matriculation certificate or marksheet	Used as the date-of-birth proof. Name spellings must match your other documents
10+2 certificate and marksheet	Needed for primary-level eligibility and for the percentage requirement
Graduation certificate and all marksheets	The percentage in the relevant subject is checked against the notification, not against your aggregate
Post-graduation documents	Required where the post or the 45% alternative route depends on it
B.Ed / D.El.Ed / B.El.Ed certificate	Must be from an NCTE-recognised institution. Some states also ask for the recognition proof
TET certificate	Must be the right paper for the level, and valid on the cut-off date the notification sets
Caste certificate, SC/ST	No expiry, but the format must match the prescribed proforma
OBC non-creamy-layer certificate	Time-limited. Must be valid at verification, not merely at application
EWS certificate	Income and asset certificate for the specified financial year, in the prescribed format
Domicile or residence certificate	Decides state reservation, and in Andhra Pradesh the district cadre
PwD certificate	Must meet the prescribed disability percentage and the notified benchmark
Ex-serviceman, freedom fighter descendant, sports quota papers	Only if claimed, and only in the prescribed format
NOC or prior intimation	Mandatory for candidates already in government, autonomous body, local body or aided-institution service
Aadhaar with a linked mobile number	Bihar requires Aadhaar verification at document verification and warns that failure to receive the OTP can affect eligibility
Photograph and signature	Bihar specifies a maximum of 20 KB, 150-220 pixels wide and 250-320 pixels tall, plus both Hindi and English signatures

Three of those rows deserve their own paragraph.

The OBC non-creamy-layer certificate is the most common casualty, because it is usually valid for one financial year and candidates obtain it at application time, then present it eight months later at verification. Get a fresh one before verification, and check whether your state accepts a certificate issued in the previous year.

The Aadhaar row is new in practice. Bihar now runs Aadhaar-based verification at document verification, requires the mobile number linked to Aadhaar, and charges a Rs.200 biometric fee at application if you do not provide an Aadhaar number. If your Aadhaar mobile number is an old, disconnected SIM, fix it now - not in the week of verification.

The NOC row catches in-service teachers who apply quietly. Andhra Pradesh's rules require candidates already working in government, autonomous bodies, local bodies or aided institutions to inform their head of

office in writing that they are applying. Doing this late, or not at all, can end the candidature.

> Build a single document folder now - physical and digital. Originals, two attested photocopies of each, and a scanned set in DigiLocker or a cloud folder named by document. Every drive this year asks for the same set, and the candidates who lose seats are the ones assembling it in the last week.

22. How merit, rosters and district cadre decide where you land

Two candidates with the same marks can end up in very different places, because selection rules sit on top of the merit list.

Reservation is applied to units, not to the state total

In Uttar Pradesh's aided-school drive, each aided school is treated as a single unit and its management committee is the appointing authority. Reservation is therefore applied school by school, based on that school's sanctioned posts - not by pooling all 17,735 posts. UPESSC issued a public clarification on 27 October 2026 after claims circulated that the roster had been computed wrongly.

What this means for you: a reserved-category candidate may be inside the cutoff for the state but outside it for a particular school's single post. Read the school-wise vacancy table, not only the subject total.

District cadre changes who your competitors are

Andhra Pradesh recruits to a district cadre, and local reservation follows the Presidential Order under Article 371-D. Your selection is valid only for the district you applied to, regardless of where you sat the exam. Choose the district deliberately: it sets both your competition and your posting for years.

Waiting lists are real, and long

Tamil Nadu's published figures show 1,12,188 TET Paper I qualified candidates and 1,69,796 Paper II qualified candidates not yet selected as on 15 April 2026. Some of those will be selected from waiting lists as vacancies arise, and some will never be. Treat a waiting-list position as a possibility, not a plan - and keep applying to other drives while you wait.

23. What the job actually pays

Pay is set by the pay matrix of the employer, and the differences between the central and state systems are large enough to matter in your choice of door.

Post	Employer	Pay level	Range per month	Age limit
Primary Teacher (PRT)	KVS / NVS	Level 6	Rs.35,400 to Rs.1,12,400	30
Trained Graduate Teacher (TGT)	KVS / NVS	Level 7	Rs.44,900 to Rs.1,42,400	35
Post Graduate Teacher (PGT)	KVS / NVS	Level 8	Rs.47,600 to Rs.1,51,100	40

Post	Employer	Pay level	Range per month	Age limit
Assistant Teacher (TGT)	Uttar Pradesh aided secondary schools	Level 7	Rs.44,900 to Rs.1,42,400	21 to 62

These are basic pay ranges in the 7th CPC pay matrix, before dearness allowance and other allowances. The progression inside a level is by annual increment, and promotion to the next level follows the employer's career-progression rules - for example, KVS TGT posts move from the entry scale at Level 7 to a senior scale at Level 8 and a selection scale at Level 10.

Two practical notes. First, a state post at Level 7 and a central post at Level 7 are not identical in take-home terms, because allowances and pension rules differ - the central system has historically offered stronger retirement benefits. Second, probation is real: KVS sets a two-year probation for direct recruits, and confirmation depends on it.

24. Ten ways candidates lose a seat they had already won

Every item here is drawn from a condition written into an official notification, not from rumour.

1. Applying at a level their qualification does not cover - most often a B.Ed holder applying for primary posts where a D.El.Ed is required.
2. Applying with a subject combination that does not match the notification's clause for that subject.
3. Holding the wrong TET paper - Paper I for a Class 6-8 post, or a CTET where the state requires its own TET.
4. Missing the fee payment date, which in several drives falls days before the application deadline.
5. Filling an incorrect height, weight or category in the form and being caught at the physical or document stage.
6. Leaving questions blank in an exam where a blank is penalised - Bihar's TRE 4.0 deducts one-third for a blank answer.
7. Scoring below the qualifying threshold in a qualifying-only section, such as Bihar's 30-mark language part, while scoring well overall.
8. Reporting to the wrong examination centre, or with a photograph that does not match the candidate's face. Both lead to cancellation, not to a re-exam.
9. Presenting an expired OBC non-creamy-layer certificate, or an EWS certificate for the wrong financial year, at verification.
10. Not informing the current employer, where the rules require an NOC or prior intimation for in-service candidates.

None of these ten is about ability. They are all about reading, dates and paperwork - which means they are all preventable, and they are the reason this book spends more pages on the system than on the syllabus.

29. Worksheets

Print these four pages. They are the working part of this book.

Worksheet 1: the document set

Document	Have original	Two photocopies	Scanned copy	Valid on verification date
Matriculation certificate / marksheet				
10+2 certificate / marksheet				
Graduation certificate and all marksheets				
Post-graduation certificate and marksheets				
B.Ed / D.El.Ed certificate				
NCTE recognition proof for the institution				
TET certificate, correct paper				
Caste / OBC-NCL / EWS certificate				
Domicile or residence certificate				
PwD certificate, if applicable				
RCI registration and CRR number, if special education				
NOC or prior intimation, if in service				
Aadhaar with linked mobile number				
Passport photographs, recent				

Worksheet 2: the 90-day grid

Week	Subject block	Pedagogy / GK block	Mock or review	Done
1				
2				
3				
4				
5				
6				
7				
8				
9				
10				
11				

Week	Subject block	Pedagogy / GK block	Mock or review	Done
12				
13				

Worksheet 3: exam-day checklist

Item	Note
Admit card, printed in colour where required	Carry two copies
Photo ID - Aadhaar where the notification specifies it	Must match the name on the admit card
Reporting time and gate closing time	Gates typically close well before the paper starts
Centre location, checked the day before	Travel time plus one hour of buffer
Blue or black ballpoint pens	Check the instruction; some papers specify the colour
Nothing electronic	Phones, smart watches and calculators are usually barred outright
For a computer-based test: the mock test done once	Know the flag-and-return buttons before you sit
Marking rule written on your hand-written note	Especially whether a blank answer is penalised

Worksheet 4: state tracker

State / employer	Exam you need	Am I eligible	Next date to watch	Applied

30. What to do in the next seven days

Everything in this book compresses into one week of decisions. Do these in order.

1. Today: write down your level - primary, upper primary, secondary or senior secondary - and your teaching subject. If two levels are open to you, note both.
2. Today: open the notification for the drive you are closest to qualifying for, and check the last date for fee payment. In Bihar that date is 2 November 2026; in Uttar Pradesh it is 23 November 2026.
3. Tomorrow: verify your teacher-training institution against the NCTE list of recognised institutions and courses. If it is not there, stop and find out why before spending anything.
4. Tomorrow: check your TET paper against the level you wrote down. If you hold Paper I and want Classes 6-8, you need Paper II, and you should plan the next TET sitting.
5. Within three days: confirm your certificate validity dates - OBC non-creamy-layer, EWS, domicile. If any expires before a likely verification date, start the renewal now.
6. Within three days: complete One Time Registration on the portal for your target drive. Both Bihar and Uttar Pradesh now require it before an application can be submitted.
7. Within a week: download the syllabus and one previous paper, sit the paper cold and untimed, and write your five weakest topics. That list is your 90-day plan.

One more thing worth doing this week, which most candidates skip: check your Aadhaar-linked mobile number. Bihar verifies Aadhaar at document verification and warns that failure to receive the OTP can affect eligibility. A fifteen-minute fix at a enrolment centre is cheaper than a lost year.

31. Sources, and how this book was checked

Every date, fee, mark, pay level and eligibility condition in this book was taken from an official document - a government notification, a commission's advertisement, a board's prospectus, a regulator's circular - and verified on 30 October 2026. Where a figure came from press reporting rather than an official document, the text says so.

Law and regulator

- Right of Children to Free and Compulsory Education Act, 2009, Section 23 - the provision that makes a TET an essential qualification.
- National Council for Teacher Education, Minimum Qualifications of Teachers, and the notifications of 23 August 2010, 29 July 2011 and amendments through 13 October 2021 - ncte.gov.in/Website/MinimumQualifications.aspx
- NCTE letter dated 9 June 2021 extending TET certificate validity to lifetime, with retrospective effect from 11 February 2011 - ncte.gov.in
- Press Information Bureau release dated 3 June 2021 on the lifetime validity of TET certificates - pib.gov.in

- CBSE, Central Teacher Eligibility Test: Introduction, Eligibility Criteria, Frequently Asked Questions and Public Notices - ctet.nic.in

State recruitment bodies

- Bihar Public Service Commission, School Teacher Recruitment Examination TRE 4.0, Advertisement No. 15/2026 dated 22 September 2026, and the subsequent extension notice - bpsc.bihar.gov.in, applications at bpsconline.bihar.gov.in
- Uttar Pradesh Education Service Selection Commission, Assistant Teacher (Trained Graduate Scale) Selection Examination 2026, Advertisement No. 07/2026 published 23 October 2026, and the commission's clarification of 27 October 2026 - upessc.up.gov.in
- Andhra Pradesh School Education Department, Brief Notification No. 1/DSC-2026/APTRT-2026 dated 13 October 2026, G.O.Ms.No.30 dated 13 October 2026, the APTET June 2026 notification dated 5 June 2026, and the AP TRT Scheme of Selection Rules in G.O.Ms.No.15 dated 19 April 2025 - tet2dsc.apcfss.in and cse.ap.gov.in
- Tamil Nadu Teachers Recruitment Board, TNTET page including pass data up to 1 October 2026 and the revised qualifying marks notified in January and February 2026 - trb.tn.gov.in
- Himachal Pradesh Board of School Education, HP TET June 2026 prospectus - hpbose.org

Central schools

- Kendriya Vidyalaya Sangathan and Navodaya Vidyalaya Samiti recruitment rules and eligibility criteria for teaching posts for the 2026-27 cycle, including pay levels, age limits and CTET requirements - kvsangathan.nic.in and the KVS-NVS detailed notification published through cbse.gov.in

How to keep this book current

Dates move. Bihar's application deadline was extended once during the writing of this book, from 26 October to 3 November 2026, and Andhra Pradesh's post count was published in three different forms within a fortnight. Treat every date here as the date as notified on 30 October 2026, and confirm it on the official portal before you act on it.

The habit that protects you is simple: bookmark the official portal for each drive you care about, and check it once a week until the exam. Not the coaching sites, not the Telegram groups - the portal. Every amendment that can affect your candidature is published there first, and it is published as a corrigendum that the aggregator sites often miss.

> This book is a guide to the system, not a substitute for the notification. Where the two differ, the notification wins, always. If a clause in this book and a clause in an official advertisement disagree, trust the advertisement and assume the book has been overtaken by an amendment.